

Work Rules & Attendance Policy – HR Policy

Effective Date: March 1, 2025

Owner: Human Resources

1. Core Working Hours

1.1 The Company's core working hours are 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM, Monday through Friday, in the employee's local time zone. All employees are expected to be online and available during these hours unless on approved leave, out of office for a meeting, or working a shift schedule approved by their manager.

1.2 The remaining 4 hours of the standard 8-hour workday are flexible. Employees may start as early as 7:00 AM and finish as late as 7:00 PM, provided they complete at least 8 total working hours (excluding a 30-minute unpaid lunch break).

1.3 For employees working across time zones (e.g., supporting global teams), the manager may approve different core hours. Such arrangements must be documented in writing and kept in the employee's HR file.

2. Leave Entitlements

2.1 Full-time employees accrue leave as follows:

a) Sick Leave (SL): 12 days per year (1 day per month). Unused sick leave does not carry over to the next year.

b) Casual Leave (CL): 15 days per year (1.25 days per month). Up to 30 unused casual leave days may be carried forward to the next year.

c) Privilege Leave (PL) / Earned Leave: Employees with more than 5 years of service receive an additional 10 days per year. This leave may be encashed upon resignation up to a maximum of 30 days.

2.2 Part-time and contract employees receive leave on a prorated basis as specified in their employment agreement. Temporary staff (less than 90 days) are not entitled to paid leave.

3. Leave Request and Approval Process

3.1 For planned leaves (vacation, personal days, religious observances), employees must submit a request in the HR portal at least 14 calendar days in advance. The request will be automatically routed to the direct manager for approval.

3.2 Managers must approve or deny leave requests within 3 business days. If no response is given within 5 business days, the request is automatically escalated to the manager's superior.

3.3 For emergency sick leave, employees must notify their manager by phone or Slack direct message before the start of core hours on the day of absence. A doctor's note may be required for sick leave exceeding 2 consecutive days.

3.4 Unapproved leave (absence without notice or approval) will be treated as an unexcused absence. Three unexcused absences in a rolling 90-day period constitute grounds for termination.

4. Late Arrival and Early Departure

4.1 Arriving more than 15 minutes after the start of core hours (10:00 AM) without prior intimation is considered late. For every 3 late arrivals in a calendar month, the employee will

receive an email reminder. For every 5 late arrivals, a half-day of casual leave will be deducted automatically.

4.2 Leaving before 4:00 PM without approval is considered early departure. For each early departure exceeding 30 minutes, the employee must make up the time within the same work week or deduct from leave balance.

4.3 Employees who are late or leave early due to a documented emergency (e.g., car breakdown, sudden illness) must inform their manager as soon as possible and may have the occurrence waived at the manager's discretion.

5. Public Holidays and Company Shutdown

5.1 The Company observes 10 public holidays per year. The list is published by HR by December 15 for the following year and includes national holidays (e.g., Republic Day, Independence Day) plus region-specific holidays based on office location.

5.2 Employees may substitute a public holiday for a different day of personal significance (e.g., religious holiday not on the official list) by requesting a swap with manager approval. The swapped day must be taken within 30 days of the public holiday.

5.3 The Company typically shuts down between December 25 and January 1. These days are counted as paid holidays and do not require employees to take leave. Critical teams (IT support, customer success) may be asked to work on a rotational basis during the shutdown, receiving compensatory off days later.

6. Attendance Tracking and Compliance

6.1 The Company uses badge swipes (for office) and system login/logout logs (for remote employees) to track attendance. Employees should badge in or log in within 15 minutes of starting work.

6.2 If an employee believes the attendance record is incorrect, they must notify HR within 5 business days of the discrepancy. After 5 days, the record is considered accurate and cannot be changed.

6.3 Habitual attendance issues (e.g., more than 2 late arrivals per week for 4 consecutive weeks) will trigger a performance improvement plan focused on time management. Failure to improve may result in termination.